Biosphere The layer of Earth in which life can exist, situated between the atmosphere and lithosphere; the sum of all ecosystems on the planet.

Botany The scientific study of plant life.

Carnivore An organism which eats only meat.

Catastrophism The theory that changes in Earth's crust were caused by dramatic and unusual events, as opposed to gradual change over time.

Cells The smallest structural and biological unit that can survive on its own; the "building blocks" of all life on Earth.

Citizen science Scientific research carried out by amateurs, typically involving large-scale data collection.

Climate change A shift in the world's interconnected weather patterns; a gradual natural process exacerbated by human actions.

Climax A biological community or ecosystem that has reached a stable point, so that populations of organisms will remain steady. This is the end result of succession, in which the type of species and population sizes that make up a community change over time.

Climax species A plant species that will not change as long as its environment remains stable.

Clutch size The number of eggs laid in one birthing.

Community ecology The study of how species interact within a given geographical space.

Competitive exclusion principle The idea that multiple species reliant on exactly the same resources cannot exist together without one population rising and the other falling, as one will always have an advantage over another.

Coniferous Describes trees with seed cones which mostly do not shed their needlelike leaves during winter.